

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

I don't think that story is true!



Learning Outcome

Describe unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you know anyone who is a very good storyteller? What makes them so good?
- Are you a good storyteller? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about coincidences and strange events.
- I can react and comment on a story.
- I can write about past events.





Let's Explore!

Sally thinks Vanessa's "friend of a friend" might not be **reliable***.

* Someone or something that is "*reliable*" can be trusted or believed.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** I have another offbeat story. I heard it at a barbecue on Memorial Day from a friend of a friend, so it might not be that reliable.
- Sally:** Yes, friends of friends always have the best, unreliable stories.
- Vanessa:** Anyway, this story happened in Florida a couple of years ago. One summer, there was a rash of break ins, but these weren't ordinary burglars. These burglars would break into people's homes when they were on vacation, at sports events, festivals ...
- Sally:** Wait! How did they know these people weren't at home?
- Vanessa:** I guess they scouted out the homes and watched them, but that's not the crazy part.
- Sally:** Ok.
- Vanessa:** Apparently, they didn't steal anything. These burglars just redecorated the homes.
- Sally:** What? They redecorated the homes?
- Vanessa:** According to the story, they also painted the walls and moved around furniture.
- Sally:** So, what did they steal?
- Vanessa:** They stole all the food in the house and left.
- Sally:** They didn't steal anything else?
- Vanessa:** I guess not.
- Sally:** Hmmm. I want to believe that story, but ...
- Vanessa:** Yeah, I know. So do I. But my friends say that story is not made up.
- Sally:** It sounds made up. I just don't believe that happened.
- Vanessa:** Actually, now that I tell it again, neither do I.
- Sally:** Yeah, I'm definitely thinking your friend of a friend is not a reliable source.
- Vanessa:** So am I. Well, this is what Google is for Sally.





Let's Practice!

Vanessa explains to Sally what the burglars did.

Instructions: Circle all the past forms in the dialogue.

1. **Sally:** What? They redecorated the homes?

Vanessa: According to the story, they also painted the walls and moved around the furniture.

Sally: So, what did they steal?

Vanessa: They stole all the food in the house and then left.

Sally: They didn't steal anything else?

Vanessa: I guess not.



Let's Practice!

Sally talks about the burglars.

Instructions: Complete the sentences with the missing words provided below.

redecorated / ate / broke in / not reliable / offbeat / heard / burglars

1. They _____ the house and _____ all the food.
2. The burglar _____ at midnight.
3. The source of the police was _____ at all.
4. It was pretty _____ what I _____ the other night.
5. I think it's insane how _____ get away from the police.





Extension Activity

That story can't be true!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write three strange short stories about yourself and your past experiences. The stories should only be a couple of sentences long.
- The stories can be true or false.
- Read one story to the group.
- Have the group comment on whether they think it is true or false.
- Have each person in the group share their story.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about coincidences and strange events.

☐ ☐

I react and comment on a story.

☐ ☐

I write about past events.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- offbeat** (adjective): not usual
e.g. I have another offbeat story.
- to break in** (verb): to make a way through
e.g. These weren't ordinary burglars that broke in to the houses.
- to scout out** (verb): to try to find something
e.g. I guess they scouted out the homes and watched them, but that's not the crazy part.
- to redecorate** (verb): to paint a room or put new objects in it
e.g. Apparently, they didn't steal anything. These burglars just redecorated the homes.
- friend of a friend** (expression): someone that you know; an acquaintance
e.g. I'm definitely thinking your friend of a friend is not a reliable source.
- reliable** (adjective): able to be trusted
e.g. I'm definitely thinking your friend of a friend is not a reliable source.
- to make up** (verb): to invent a story
e.g. But my friends say that story is not made up.





Learning Points

Simple Past

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about many kinds of past events: short, quickly finished actions, longer situations and repeated events.

Usually, when you use the Simple Past tense, the time of the finished action is clear from the context or explicitly mentioned in the sentence.

For example:

*Burglars **robbed** the house when they were on vacation.*

Here is another example:

*Last summer, they **redecorated** their house.*

Remember that there are both regular and irregular verbs. Look at the chart for examples of the Simple Past tense verbs.

Regular Verbs:

Present	Past
discover	discovered
recognize	recognized

Irregular Verbs:

Present	Past
think	thought
know	knew

Examples:

- *They **redecorated** the homes?*
- *So, what **did** they **steal**?*
- *They **stole** all the food in the house and left.*
- *They **didn't** steal anything else?*





Learning Points

The Position of Not

When you want to emphasize that something or an action is opposite to what is expected, use *not*, rather than a contraction in the sentence.

For example: *They say the storyteller is not reliable. The article's writer is not truthful.*

The **not** shows a firmness on the part of the speaker while still being polite.

Statement	Meaning
<i>They say they are not the most reliable people.</i>	They shouldn't be trusted.
<i>They say it's not true.</i>	It is false.
<i>My friends say that story is not made up.</i>	The story is not false.
<i>We did not, thank goodness.</i>	We're happy we didn't do it.

So is used to show agreement with positive statements:

So + Auxiliary/Be + Subject (pronoun)

It is similar to using **too** at the end of a sentence.

Frank: *I am happy.*

Lucy: *So am I. (I am happy too.)*

Frank: *I think the story is untrue.*

Lucy: *So do I. (I think the story is false too.)*

Neither is used to show agreement with negative statements.

Neither + Auxiliary + Subject (pronoun)

The Auxiliary needs to agree with the verb tense in the original statement.

It is similar to using **either** at the end of a sentence, although **neither** is more commonly used, especially in spoken English.

Frank: *I don't believe that story.*

Lucy: *Neither do I. (= I don't believe it either.)*

Examples:

- *It might not be that reliable.*
- *I'm definitely thinking your friend of a friend is not a reliable source.*
- *But my friends say that story is not made up.*
- **Lucy:** *I just don't believe that happened.* **Frank:** *Actually, now that I tell it again, neither do I.*

